

NEOTROPOLIS GLOSSARY

Version 2.1

Some of these terms are specifically for the world of Neotropolis (Synaptix, for example), some of them are general terms used across sci-fi (like FTL standing for Faster Than Light), and some of them are actual real-world Earth terms just being used in a new context for our world (such as promethium).

Also includes people of note within the power structure of Neotropolis.

(We do our best not to use any terms that were created specifically for an outside intellectual property.)



Blue Silver - A local slang term for Promethium, due to its silver color and its pale blue luminescence from radioactivity. See Promethium.

Carniya (pronounced car-nigh-uh) – A race of non-human aliens from a remote planet in the Eta Carinae system. The Carniya have had little human contact outside of a few interactions with remote mining and research stations where they functioned as smugglers of restricted goods.

Core - The Core is the main entertainment area in the city of Neotropolis. Acts come from all over the galaxy to perform there.

Coronado Precision Engineering – A small, cutting-edge company specializing in experimental interplanetary travel technology.

Cult of '84 - Part cult, part cultural movement. One of the more visible examples of a fascination with Earth culture from the 1980s which has inspired everything from fashion to religious sects. Whether it was the result of old media broadcasts from Earth bouncing through the galaxy and finally hitting a relay probe near Proxima Centauri, or a stash of 240-year-old Smash Hits magazines found in a cargo hold and mistaken for religious texts, the year 1984 is now widely considered by some to have been the peak of old Earth civilization.

Cygni Alpha 12 - A planet in the Cygnus federation of systems. Previously the base of the Cygni Resistance before the assault by Endline forces in 2224. Current status of the Cygni Resistance is unknown.

Cygni Alpha 12 Resistance - Also known simply as “Cygni Resistance” - An insurgent movement based on the planet Alpha 12 in the Cygni system, only loosely tied to the Kepler Resistance. Their secret headquarters was assaulted by Endline forces in 2224 and believed to be completely wiped out. Current status of the Cygni Resistance is unknown.

Cygnus Constellation - When viewed from earth, the cluster of stars in in this constellation are in the shape of a swan (Cygnus is the Latinized Greek word for swan).

Cygnus Federation (of systems) - a loose, independent galactic organization whose motto is “Libertas - Occasio” (Liberty & Opportunity). Neotropolis is within the Cygnus Federation. Other populated star systems in the Cygnus Federation include Gliese and Cygni.

Director “Crash” Carver – The head of Kepler Sky Control. The nickname of “Crash” was given to him ironically because no ship has ever crashed on his watch.

Dr. Cyril Hayes – The deceased former head of Neotropolis Tech Sector. Revered as the smartest man on the planet, he died while studying the mysterious Extari ship, the KS-808.

Dr. Kit Faro – The current head of Tech Sector, having taken over from the late Dr. Hayes. In addition to being the most senior scientist on the planet, she also holds certain emergency authority powers granted to her in the absence of an established central government on Kepler-609c.

Endline Solutions - A bounty hunting and private security contracting corporation. Endline has more military power than most national armies, and they have influence throughout the galaxy. They monetize everything from private executive protection, to bounty hunting, to weaponized human augmentation.

Energy Farm - An area of energy production that provides much of the power for the city.

Extari – Name created by Tech Sector to name an alien race that little is known about (including their actual name). They are believed to be the creators of the space ship known as KS-808 (later N.S.S. Kanly).

Food Brands – Some of the current popular mass-produced food bands in the galaxy include: Soda/energy drink brands *Gluggo (and Gluggo Blast)*, *CloyPop*, *Zlizz*, and *Dr. Redline*.

Snack chips: *Chux (and Holo Chux)*, *Saltzees*, *Cranch*, *Dangles*, and *Parch's Salt Wafers*.

Candy: *Crystal Crunchies*, *Sugah Shockas*, *Dusties*, *Fat Bar*, *Goo Bar*, *StickeeZ*, *Mush*

Dropz, and *Gulletz*.

Fast food/burger restaurant chains: *McBloaties*, *Greezies*, *Frytown* (home of the *Gruburger*), *Brown Charlie's*, and *Gristle's Castle* (home of the *WiggleBurger*).

Food vending machines: *Gulp-O-Mat*, *Foodtronix*, and *Pick-n-swallow*.

(see also, *krill*)

FTL - FTL is short for “Faster than light”. Transportation faster than the speed of light that enables travel between planets and star systems.

Ganymede - The largest moon orbiting the planet Jupiter (the moon is actually larger than the planet Mercury) and the location of the Helix Industries home office. Helix Home Office is, in fact, a massive, city-like complex and Helix owns the entire moon of Ganymede.

Gliese - A planet system in the Cygnus federation of systems. They orbit the red dwarf star Gliese 581.

Grid - The streets of Neotropolis City. A restricted area for those vehicles with a Grid Rider Permit.

Grid Rider Permit - A pass displayed on a vehicle showing that it is authorized to operate on the streets of the city (requires an inspection process).

Guardian Council – A temporary special committee formed by Dr. Kit Faro for organizing the ad hoc defense of the planet from possible alien attack.

Helix Industries - One of the wealthiest and most powerful corporations in the entire galaxy. Helix manufactures everything from starships to pharmaceuticals and artificial organs.

Kepler-609b - A giant uninhabitable planet in the Kepler system. Sometimes called the “big sister” to Kepler-609c.

Kepler-609c - The official name for the home planet of the city of Neotropolis. Because the city is the only population center, the planet itself is often simply called “Neotropolis” as well, or sometimes simply “609” (since 609b is not habitable). Though locals sometimes also refer to the planet as simply “Kepler,” this usage can cause confusion because there are thousands of other planets that include the name “Kepler.”

Kepler Sky Control - Operating as a sort of hybrid of an air traffic control organization and space agency (similar to Earth’s NASA), KSC is an independent unit tasked with monitoring all ship traffic on and around Kepler-609c.

Kepler Space Port - The primary landing zone for on-planet and interplanetary travel. Under the authority of Kepler Sky Control.

Kepler Spire - A sophisticated communications array owned by Helix. It was intended to better connect Neotropolis with the rest of the neighboring systems, but it was hacked by the Resistance on Kepler shortly after it was unveiled and activated in 2224.

Krill - After the extinction of Earth's lobsters and shrimp, krill became a popular food item across the galaxy. Farmed in large numbers on watery planets, the giant krill variety can reach as large as 10cm. The Krill House is a popular restaurant chain in the near Earth systems (one that nearly went out of business and nearly caused another extinction due to their "all-you-can-eat krill Thursdays.")
On a desert planet like Kepler-609c, krill are more of a rare, imported delicacy.
(See also, **food brands**)

KS-808 – Designation given to a mysterious space craft of Extari origin (see **Extari**) that appeared on planet in the year 2225. (KS-808 is short for Kepler Sky 808). It was named that by Kepler Sky Control because it is an unidentified object of unknown origin (the eight hundredth and eighty eighth one they have discovered, though most of the others were much smaller and many of them never entered the planet's orbit). It was later refurbished with human technology and renamed (see **N.S.S. Kanly**).

Laser Combat League - An interplanetary athletic organization that oversees Laser Tag tournaments, disc combat, and other laser sporting events.

Main Drag - The common name for Second Avenue in Downtown Neotropolis.

The Maze - The local name for the dangerous southern section of Neotropolis's Megablock One. The maze was cordoned off from the wealthier portions of the city years ago and fell into disrepair. It has become a dangerous neighborhood filled with criminals, squatters, and elements of the Resistance. But a thriving underground economy still operates within the maze and neither the Sentinels nor the local corporate powers have succeeded in clearing it out.

Martian Mint – One of the galaxy's primary manufacturers of hard currency.

Megablock One - The largest populated neighborhood within Neotropolis City. This large city block contains everything from municipal services and corporate offices in its northern sectors, to condemned slums in the southern section (known as "the Maze").

MegaMerchMall - The largest shopping complex on Neotropolis, located in the Midtown Plaza sector.

N3 - Neotropolis News Network - The leading media channel on-planet, reporting on all of the news regarding Neotropolis and nearby systems.

Nomatech Arms – A well-known gun manufacturer of small arms (blasters and other sidearms, mostly).

Neobet - The alphabet commonly used on Neotropolis (though the Old Earth Roman alphabet and languages are common as well).

NeoBand - A wristband worn by some of the denizens of Neotropolis. It contains personal identity information and is interactive with certain devices.

NeoCredits - Slang term for Neotropolis Credits. The primary currency on Neotropolis.

Neotropolis - The largest population center on planet Kepler-609c. Because it is the only built up area on-planet, it is often used as a slang term for the whole planet itself.

NPC aka Neotropolis Power & Cable - The main electrical utility provider for Neotropolis. Their “NPC” initials have a similarity to an old gaming term and has been known to cause confusion.

N.S.S. Kanly – A small space craft, previously designated KS-808. It contains a combination of human and Extari technology.

Orbital Engineering Detachment (O.E.D.) – Highly trained construction unit that specializes in building and repair jobs in planetary orbit (for example, construction and maintenance of the promethium refineries in the rings of Kepler-609c.)

Organ Etching – A procedure where code numbers are inscribed on a person’s vital organs in order to deter organ thieves from harvesting them on the red market. A visible tattoo is sometimes included with the service so that organ thieves will be deterred before they bother cutting. (This seldom helps anymore since some poorer people just started paying for counterfeit tattoos without getting the etching.)

Outer Zone - The more sparsely populated area of Kepler-609c, just outside the borders of Neo City.

Pras - Persistent rejective augmentation syndrome. A condition where the body’s immune system has a negative reaction to certain artificial enhancements. This condition was treated with Synaptix, before that drug became illegal.

Promethium - This extremely rare and valuable element exists in higher concentrations on Kepler-609c than it does in most other parts of the galaxy. Promethium is mostly

mined at the planet's polar cap or extracted via orbital mining out in the planet's rings. Promethium is key to powering the most advanced deep space probes.

Rations Row - The culinary capital of Neotropolis City, with the largest concentration of restaurants and food stalls.

Reboot Syndicate – The newest corporation in Neotropolis. Reboot Syndicate is ostensibly a financial services corp focused on debt consolidation, loans, workers' pensions, and "creative" investments... but many believe it is nothing more than a front for the Neotropolis Resistance, using the galaxy's broad corporate protection statutes (such as the Corporate Privacy and Preservation Act of 2089) to hide their activities.

Resistance (aka Kepler Resistance) - A patchwork alliance of hackers, criminals, political firebrands, longtime local residents, and religious zealots, the Resistance slowly and secretly banded together from all strata of Neo society. Their stated goals include wresting control away from the corporations and the pseudo-military to create a world for themselves.

Revamine (also known as **rev**) (pronounced rev-uh-mean) - a powerful, lab-created stimulant, usually distributed in a powdered or crystalline form, in a variety of colors. Rev was first used by hard laborers on Neotropolis to keep stay alert on long shifts, but it quickly became a favored drug for recreational and party use. It is an illegal, controlled substance and the Sentinels have regularly confiscated shipments and arrested dealers/users.

The drug is highly addictive and too much rev use can lead to trademark twitches and jitters among addicts. Overdoses are not uncommon when users get "revved up" or "revved out" and this is sometimes called "redlining."

Ringers - Slang term for the orbital miners who do the dangerous work of mining promethium from the Kepler-609c's rings.

Sentinels - An independent security team that is not aligned or owned by any allegiance. These "peacekeepers" do their best to enforce some version of law and order in Neotropolis. Their services are sometimes available to the highest bidder and their loyalties are not always clear. Some of the members of the Sentinels are true believers, while some are just conscripts forced to join up to pay off corporate debts.

Splendor Protocol – A controversial proprietary Helix Industries technology. Helix claimed it was a beneficial brain mapping application, but some claimed it was a form of mind control. Endline Solutions was able to study the stealth technology on the mysterious Extari space ship and created a way to block the Splendor Protocol.

Synaptix (also known by the slang terms **Slap**, **Snap**, or **Patch**) - Synaptix (synapitreticktriptaphane) was originally a prescription medication from

pharmaceutical company Novagen (a division of Helix Industries) distributed in 50mg dermal patches. Synaptix was developed as a treatment for biome imbalance and persistent rejective augmentation syndrome (pras). The dermal patches quickly became a highly sought after and highly addictive street drug (both for off-label medical use and to induce brief euphoria). Synaptix is now illegal.

Tech Sector (aka Tec Sec) - a scientific body that works for the benefit of all citizens, not tied to any particular corporation or allegiance. Tec Sec was partly responsible for the initial refinement of promethium on Kepler, and made certain refining patents public for the advancement of human interstellar travel. Their fiercely independent stance and strict adherence to the ideas of bettering all human kind has made them popular among the local citizens, and the corporations tend to try and stay on good footing with them as well.

Walton Dynamics – A very large corporation (even by galactic standards) and a major player in the interplanetary military industrial complex.

Wormhole – The most common way to travel long distances across the galaxy. Wormholes may be naturally occurring or artificial and some are privately owned, collecting hefty tolls for their use. Certain powers have even set up illegal blockades of natural wormholes to charge what basically amounts to a ransom for their use. Wormholes are fixed points in space and there are a finite number of them. Therefore, if you are going to a system/destination that is not that close to a wormhole, you may still need a combination of FTL and cryo sleep for sometimes very long (even multi-year) journeys. Note: Artificial worm holes are incredibly difficult and expensive to create, and there are currently no spacecraft that can create their own.